COMS BC3997 (Applied Cryptography) October 26, 2026

Final Project Proposal

Instructor: Eysa Lee *Due: November 4, 2026*

1 Project Information

Students should complete a final project on a cryptography or security topic of their choice, subject to instructor approval. The first stage of the project will consist of a (short) literature study of the selected area and a tentative identification of the problem and what you hope to achieve. You may discuss your project and ideas with others (in this class and outside of it) and incorporate feedback as long as you give them proper credit. However, remember this is *your* final project, and the final result should primarily consist of your work. **You should not be using AI for developing ideas**. As stated on the first day of class and repeated on assignments, **the only acceptable use of AI in this course is for assistance with implementation**.

1.1 Proposal

Your project proposal may be quite short (1, maybe 2 pages) but should contain the following components:

1. Project Title
2. General area/question you'd like to investigate. Optionally, you can include the reason you selected this area.
3. References to literature you intend to read or have already read. *This does not need to be a comprehensive literature review.* You need to show that what you have chosen is appropriate for a final project and that you have put some thought into the starting point.
4. Preliminary list of deliverables for the final project. This will likely be a combination of a write-up of findings, an implementation, and/or a protocol design. You may give a range of deliverables if you believe your goals will be influenced by findings.
5. Give an initial plan and timeline for achieving your deliverables. Indicate what you hope to achieve by the Progress Report deadline (Nov 18).

While you are not bound to the deliverables or topic you state in your proposal, you will need to receive approval if you wish to deviate significantly from what you initially proposed (e.g., completely changing topics). You are encouraged to start early and to reach out to me for feedback. I'm happy to help find a project.

1.2 Submission Instructions

You will submit your project proposal as a PDF via email to me by November 4, 2026. Please title your email "**[BC3997] Final Project Proposal -** " followed by your name. For example, my email would be titled [BC3997] Final Project Proposal - Eysa Lee. I will reply via email if your proposal is approved or if you need to make modifications.